

Meridian Health Plan

Prior Authorization Request Form — Outpatient Services

Requesting Provider Information

Provider Name:	Dr. Anita Coleman, MD
Practice:	Westbrook Orthopedic Associates
NPI:	1922837465
Tax ID:	88-1039221
Contact Phone:	(602) 555-0148
Fax:	(602) 555-0149

Patient Information

Patient Name:	Marcus T. Reeves
Patient ID:	PT-559201
Date of Birth:	04/11/1978
Member ID:	MHP-77410-A
Group Number:	GRP-22190

Requested Service

CPT Code:	29881 — Arthroscopy, knee, surgical; with meniscectomy
ICD-10 Code:	M23.221 — Derangement of medial meniscus, right knee
Place of Service:	Outpatient Surgical Center
Requested Date:	2026-07-15
Units:	1
Est. Charge Amount:	\$18,900.00

Clinical Justification

Patient presents with persistent right knee pain and mechanical locking symptoms for 10 weeks, unresponsive to 6 weeks of conservative therapy including physical therapy, NSAIDs, and activity modification. MRI dated 06/02/2026 confirms a complex tear of the medial meniscus. Surgical intervention is recommended to restore function and prevent further joint degeneration.

Submitted By:	Westbrook Orthopedic Associates — Authorizations Dept.
Submission Date:	2026-06-25
Reference #:	PA-2026-661204

Meridian Health Plan

Utilization Management Department
1400 Concourse Parkway, Suite 300, Phoenix, AZ 85034

Date: 2026-07-02
Marcus T. Reeves
PT-559201
Member ID: MHP-77410-A

RE: Notice of Adverse Benefit Determination

Reference #:	PA-2026-661204
Claim #:	HC-CLM-77410
Service:	CPT 29881 — Knee Arthroscopy w/ Meniscectomy
Requested Date:	2026-07-15
Determination:	DENIED
Denial Reason Code:	MN-07 — Medical necessity not established

Explanation

Dear Mr. Reeves,

After review by our Medical Director, the requested procedure (CPT 29881) has been denied. Our clinical review determined that the submitted documentation does not demonstrate that a minimum of 6 weeks of conservative treatment was fully exhausted and documented per Meridian Health Plan's Musculoskeletal Surgery Guideline MSK-014. Specifically, physical therapy visit notes and a formal re-evaluation following the conservative treatment course were not included with this request.

Appeal Rights

You or your provider have the right to request a formal appeal of this decision within 180 days of this notice. Appeals should be submitted in writing to the address above, Attn: Appeals & Grievances, and should include any additional supporting clinical documentation, including physical therapy records and a physician re-evaluation note.

Sincerely,
Dr. Rachel Okafor, MD
Medical Director, Meridian Health Plan

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